

Prayers for our World and the Church

12th April 2026

Hebrews 4:16

Therefore let us draw near with confidence to the throne of grace, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You receive us with mercy when we approach Your throne of grace.

We know that we could not come except for the saving work of Jesus, and His intercession on our behalf. We thank You that we have been forgiven because He went to the Cross, on our behalf. We recognise that You are the One and Only God, holy and righteous, but we thank You that we can come confidently because Jesus has taken away our sin and given us His righteousness as a free gift.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We thank You for the Church, the Body of Christ, the pillar of Truth, down through the ages. We remember the cloud of witnesses, those who have gone before us, who have taken Your Word to every corner of this world, and those who dared to witness to us of Your love for a lost world, and especially Your particular love for us as individuals.

We thank You for the Holy Spirit Who led and guided those who preserved and translated Your written Word so that we could read it for ourselves, and be guided by Your wisdom daily. We thank You for the work of SIL and Wycliffe, and we thank You for calling people to serve in so many ways to carry on that work today. We pray for Sebastian and Betty and the family as they prepare to return to PNG, after a long break. Grant them strength, endurance and clarity of vision, so that they may overcome any hurdles that would hinder them from doing Your will.

We pray for this world where so many live in darkness, and we long for them to see the light of the gospel in their own language as the work of translation continues to bring them to the Cross, to know Your love, as we know it here.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, and we dedicate ourselves afresh in Your service, so that we too may see the good news spread far and wide. May all we do and say be a blessing to one another, as well as to those we meet with daily, knowing that our own nation is as much a mission field as any other.

We continue in prayer for those in need among us, as we express our care for each other, and our desire to grow in grace, in fellowship and in Godly wisdom, so that the Body of Christ here may be built up to fulfill Your purposes more fully.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Harrison as he preaches today. We pray that we would be diligent hearers and do-ers of Your Word, making the most of the means of grace, and that we may encourage him as he preaches.

In Jesus' Precious Name we pray, Amen.